

Gym, Office & Academy Management — Feature, Function & Flow Reference

Contents

Part 1 — Gym / Fitness Club Management

- 1.1 Membership models — what you're actually selling
- 1.2 Billing mechanics — the fiddly parts
- 1.3 Check-in & access control
- 1.4 Scheduling & booking
- 1.5 Sales funnel & CRM
- 1.6 Retention & churn
- 1.7 Staff, payroll, multi-location & retail
- 1.8 Full gym flow

Part 2 — Office Management (Internal Staff Operations)

- 2.1 Scope note — what this is, and what it deliberately isn't
- 2.2 Employee directory & org structure
- 2.3 Attendance
- 2.4 Leave management
- 2.5 Approvals & workflows
- 2.6 HR self-service (onboarding / offboarding)
- 2.7 Announcements
- 2.8 Reporting
- 2.9 Full office (HR/staff-ops) flow

Part 3 — Academy / Coaching Institute Management

- 3.1 Institution types
- 3.2 Admissions & enrollment
- 3.3 Student records
- 3.4 Attendance — methods and workflows
- 3.5 Timetable & batch scheduling
- 3.6 Teaching: assignments, quizzes, LMS
- 3.7 Assessment, gradebook, report cards
- 3.8 Fees
- 3.9 Communication & portals
- 3.10 Ancillary modules
- 3.11 Coaching-institute specifics
- 3.12 Full academy flow

Part 4 — Cross-Cutting Primitives (Common to All Three Verticals)

Part 5 — Feature Count Summary

Sources

Gym, Office & Academy Management — Feature, Function & Flow Reference

A consolidated reference covering gym/club operations, internal office (HR/staff) management, and academy/coaching-institute operations — organized by feature, function, and workflow for platform design purposes.

Contents

Part 1 — Gym / Fitness Club Management 1.1 Membership models · 1.2 Billing mechanics · 1.3 Check-in & access control · 1.4 Scheduling & booking · 1.5 Sales funnel & CRM · 1.6 Retention & churn · 1.7 Staff, payroll, multi-location & retail · 1.8 Full flow

Part 2 — Office Management (Internal Staff Operations) 2.1 Scope note · 2.2 Employee directory & org structure · 2.3 Attendance · 2.4 Leave management · 2.5 Approvals & workflows · 2.6 HR self-service · 2.7 Announcements · 2.8 Reporting · 2.9 Full flow

Part 3 — Academy / Coaching Institute Management 3.1

Institution types · 3.2 Admissions & enrollment · 3.3 Student records · 3.4 Attendance · 3.5 Timetable & batch scheduling · 3.6 Teaching: assignments, quizzes, LMS · 3.7 Assessment, gradebook, report cards · 3.8 Fees · 3.9 Communication & portals · 3.10 Ancillary modules · 3.11 Coaching-institute specifics · 3.12 Full flow

Part 4 — Cross-Cutting Primitives Part 5 — Feature Count Summary Sources

Part 1 — Gym / Fitness Club Management

1.1 Membership models — what you're actually selling

Model	Mechanics	Why operators use it
Recurring — unlimited	Flat monthly fee, all access	Best retention (cancelling takes action), predictable MRR; needs capacity management
Recurring — capped	N classes/month (typically 8 or 12) at lower price	Cheaper entry point, caps cost exposure
Annual	12-month commitment at discounted monthly equivalent	Strongest retention, upfront cash
Non-recurring	One-time payment, expires in days/weeks/months	Day passes, week trials, seasonal packages
Punchcard / class pack	Prepaid N sessions with expiry (60 days for 5-class, 90-120 for 10-class, 6 months for 20-class)	Bridges the gap for people not ready to commit; priced 15-25% below drop-in
Drop-in / day pass	Pay-per-session	Cash flow, but low retention and poor predictability
Personal training	Single sessions, 5/12/20-session packs, or recurring PT membership	Highest margin; PT clients churn ~70% less

Most successful gyms run several models simultaneously as a funnel: intro offer → class pass → monthly membership.

1.2 Billing mechanics — the fiddly parts

- **Billing interval** — weekly or monthly
- **Interval count** — monthly = 1, bi-weekly = 2, quarterly = 3
- **Billing day** — anniversary (charge on purchase date, no proration) or fixed day (e.g. the 1st, first payment prorated)
- **Setup fee** — charged at signup for key fobs, onboarding

- **Commitment period** — e.g. 3-month minimum then auto-renewing month-to-month, or a 12-month contract
- **Freeze / pause** — must release future reservations and remove the member from waitlists
- **Cancellation** — usually written notice, commonly 10-30 days before the next payment date
- **Non-refundable by default** — memberships, packs, passes, intro offers

Constraint worth building for: plan type, billing interval, and billing day generally cannot be changed after plan creation — changing them retroactively corrupts revenue recognition.

1.3 Check-in & access control

Method	Trade-off
Mobile app / QR	Fastest-growing; time-based QR refreshing every 30s prevents screenshot sharing
Kiosk / tablet self check-in	Frees the front desk, enables 24/7 access
Key fob / RFID	Frictionless, cheap, survives sweat and water — the workhorse
Biometric (fingerprint, face, palm)	Highest security, no card to share; privacy-sensitive — offer a non-biometric alternative
Barcode / front-desk lookup	Fallback and legacy

Hardware capabilities that matter: real-time membership sync (expired/unpaid memberships block at the gate instantly), anti-tailgating sensors, offline recording with sync-on-reconnect, and sub-second verification.

Illustrative outcomes from the research: facial recognition cut membership fraud by up to 90% at one club; QR speed gates lifted class attendance ~15%; clubs lost up to 12% of new joiners within 3 months when peak-hour queues exceeded 4 minutes.

1.4 Scheduling & booking

Three models coexist in one system: group classes (fixed weekly schedule, capacity limits), personal training (individual appointments with a specific trainer), and hybrid/semi-private (small groups with trainer assignment).

Waitlists — the highest-value feature here. Key mechanics: automatic promotion when someone cancels, a timed confirmation window (30-60 min) so the spot doesn't rot, and first-confirmed logic. A well-run waitlist recovers 60-80% of cancelled class spots.

No-shows — the central operational problem. Benchmarks: 25-40% for free/low-cost trials, ~15% average for classes. Requiring prepayment drops it from 25%+ to under 5%. Reminders 2-4 hours before, sent from the trainer's identity, outperform generic ones. Cancellation deadlines of 2-12 hours with forfeiture policies are standard.

Personal training specifics: - Per-trainer availability calendars - Session package tracking with remaining-count display - Recurring appointments (e.g. every Tue/Thu 7am) - Minimum booking notice (4-

12h) and buffer time between sessions (15-30 min) - Variable durations (30/45/60/90 min)

1.5 Sales funnel & CRM

The common failure pattern: a prospect books a trial, enjoys it, says “I’ll sign up later,” nobody follows up, and they join a competitor that called back.

Standard pipeline: New enquiry → Assigned → Contacted → Trial booked → Attended → Joined / Lost. (“Attended” requires actual attendance, not just a booking.)

Conversion benchmarks: most gyms convert 10-15% of enquiries; top performers hit 20-30% with structured follow-up. Systematic trial follow-up yields 25-40% more conversions from the same number of trials.

Typical automation: a Day 1 check-in, Day 3 offer, Day 7 final-nudge sequence — with event-based rules (booking a trial stops the enquiry sequence and starts trial reminders; a reply pauses automation and creates a staff task).

1.6 Retention & churn

- Visit frequency is the early-warning signal — members visiting fewer than twice a week churn at materially higher rates
- “Time since last visit” is the single most actionable number — a widening gap precedes cancellation
- First 30/60/90 days is the highest-risk window; class no-shows are also a churn signal
- Retention tooling: renewal reminders before expiry and on due date, loyalty points, churn prediction, win-back sequences for lapsed members

One cited case: retention rose from 45% to 80% within three months after automated reminders were introduced.

1.7 Staff, payroll, multi-location & retail

Payroll components: fixed salary, hourly (regular/overtime/weekend), per-class (paid only if the trainer actually checked in), commission on referred members.

Multi-location requirements: centralized brand/reporting/payments with local flexibility; roaming memberships and cross-location transfer; network-wide credentials with instant suspension for non-payers; centralized rota with labour-to-sales tracking; POS reconciliation at end of night.

1.8 Full gym flow

Lead captured (walk-in / web / social / ads)

→ Trial booked → Trial attended → Follow-up sequence

→ Converts to membership (plan + billing interval + billing day set)

→ First payment processed → Access credential issued

(app/fob/biometric)

→ Member checks in → Books classes / PT sessions → Attends or no-shows

→ Recurring billing cycles → Churn-risk signals monitored

→ Renewal reminder → Renews / freezes / cancels

Approximate scope: ~20 modules, roughly 150+ discrete features.

Part 2 — Office Management (Internal Staff Operations)

2.1 Scope note — what this is, and what it deliberately isn't

Excluded from this scope: office space rental/leasing, coworking operator billing, desk/meeting-room booking as a revenue product, visitor management, facility/asset maintenance (CAFM/IWMS), and project/task management. None of that belongs in this module.

What this module actually is: internal staff/HR operations for a company's own office — the same underlying shape as the gym's "members + attendance + billing" or the academy's "students + attendance + records," just applied to employees. Core focus: **employee directory, attendance, leave, and approvals** — no project or task tracking.

2.2 Employee directory & org structure

- Employee profile: name, designation, department, contact info, employment status (active / on leave / terminated)
- Reporting hierarchy — direct manager, org chart view
- Departments & teams — structure, headcount per unit
- Searchable/filterable directory (by name, department, designation, location)
- Role-based visibility — a manager sees their team; HR sees everyone; employees see limited peer info

2.3 Attendance

Method	Notes
Biometric (fingerprint, face)	High accuracy, prevents proxy/buddy check-ins; privacy-sensitive, needs consent and a fallback option
QR / app check-in	Low cost, works for hybrid or field staff; can include geofencing
RFID / card	Contactless, fast, good for badge-based offices
Manual / web entry	Fallback for exceptions and regularization requests

- Daily/monthly attendance percentage per employee and per department
- Late-arrival tracking with configurable grace periods
- Regularization requests — employee flags a missed/incorrect punch, manager approves
- Timesheet view — clock-in/out history, total hours per day/week/month

2.4 Leave management

- Leave types: sick, casual, annual/earned, unpaid, and custom types as needed
- Leave balance accrual — per employee, per leave type, per year (or pro-rated for new joiners)
- Application flow: employee applies → manager approves/rejects → HR final approval (chain configurable)
- Team leave calendar — visibility into who's out and when, to avoid overlap
- Company holiday calendar
- Leave history and carry-forward rules

2.5 Approvals & workflows

A generalized approval engine beyond leave alone:

- Expense claim requests
- Work-from-home / remote-work requests
- Access requests (systems, physical access)
- Configurable routing chains (employee → manager → department head → HR, as needed per request type)
- Full audit trail — who approved, when, and any comments

2.6 HR self-service (onboarding / offboarding)

- Document storage — payslips, offer letters, contracts, ID proofs
- Onboarding checklist for new hires (documents to submit, systems to be provisioned, orientation steps)
- Offboarding checklist for exits (asset return, access revocation, final settlement steps)
- Employee self-service portal to view/download their own records

2.7 Announcements

- Company-wide announcements feed
- Department-scoped announcements
- Priority / action-required tagging
- Optional read receipts

2.8 Reporting

- Attendance trends — by employee, department, and company-wide
- Leave utilization and balance summaries
- Headcount by department, over time
- Approval turnaround time (how long requests sit before resolution)

2.9 Full office (HR/staff-ops) flow

Employee onboarded (profile created, department/manager assigned)

→ Leave balance initialized → Daily attendance recorded

(biometric/QR/manual)

→ Late arrivals / missed punches flagged → Regularization

requested if needed

→ Leave applied → Manager approval → HR approval → Leave balance

updated

→ Monthly attendance/leave report generated

→ (On exit) Offboarding checklist triggered → Access revoked → Final settlement

Approximate scope (this corrected, narrower definition): ~7 modules, roughly 50–60 discrete features.

Part 3 — Academy / Coaching Institute Management

3.1 Institution types

K-12 school · college/university · tutoring centre · coaching/test-prep institute · skill academy · preschool · music/dance/sports academy. The features below emphasize the last four, which is the more likely platform target.

3.2 Admissions & enrollment

- Inquiry → applicant → enrolled, with configurable stages (pending / admitted / rejected / withdrawn)
- Public online admission forms embeddable on a website
- Entrance tests, document upload, printable application forms
- Guardian/parent records linked to students, with relationship and contact tracking
- Enrollment history, class/section placement, online registration
- Waitlists and capacity limits per batch

3.3 Student records

Biographical data, program data, medical data/immunizations, critical flags, a virtual file cabinet for documents, academic history (including imported historical grades), and discipline/behaviour records.

3.4 Attendance — methods and workflows

Method	Notes
Biometric (fingerprint, face)	Highest accuracy, prevents proxy attendance; needs parental consent and a non-biometric alternative
RFID	Card/tag/wristband tapped at classroom or gate readers; contactless, good for unstaffed entry points
QR	Lowest cost — unique per student, or class-specific time-bound codes, sometimes with location verification
Manual roll-call	Web/mobile marking, works offline with sync
Smart ID / barcode	Legacy but still common

- Parent absence alerts within minutes via SMS/email/WhatsApp, with duplicate-notification prevention
- Late-arrival alerts logging arrival time and delay minutes

- Leave request and approval chains (class teacher → coordinator → principal)
- Absence categorisation — excused/unexcused, medical, sick, authorized
- At-risk / chronic-absenteeism flags for counsellors
- Daily summaries and weekly/monthly attendance-percentage reports to parents
- Two-way communication — parents confirm absences or ask questions, with a full audit trail

3.5 Timetable & batch scheduling

- Batch types: individual (1:1), group, online, offline (with venue) — progress/reports stay individual even within group batches
- Period-by-period grids with teacher, room, and subject allocation, plus conflict detection (double-booked teacher or room)
- Recurring session patterns (e.g. Mon/Wed/Fri 4–6 PM) with sessions auto-generated from the pattern
- Substitute teacher assignment with notifications to students, parents, and tutors
- Self-paced tracks alongside fixed timetables
- Morning/evening/weekend batch management with capacity tracking

3.6 Teaching: assignments, quizzes, LMS

- Assignments — file submission, multimedia/video assignments, e-portfolio submissions
- Quizzes — multiple question types, question banks, randomisation, timed quizzes, mock exams
- Rubrics — customisable, attachable to assignments, mappable to skills/competencies
- Plagiarism detection on submissions
- Discussion forums — asynchronous, sometimes with helpful-post rating
- Doubt sessions — 1:1 doubt-clearing slots, in-app doubt submission, tutor chat, mentor callback requests (a first-class feature in coaching institutes, not an afterthought)

3.7 Assessment, gradebook, report cards

- Gradebook — weighting, grading scales, standards-based and traditional grading, missing-assignment tracking
- Exams — scheduling, hall tickets, question banks, online exam delivery, automated result processing, rank generation
- Report cards & transcripts — letter/number grades, standards-based formats, per-term posting
- Progress reports — per-student performance dashboard, subject/topic strength-weakness breakdown, at-risk flags, exportable for parent meetings

3.8 Fees

- Fee heads (tuition, materials, transport, exam, lab) and class-wise fee structures
- Installments linked to invoices with configurable installment counts and due dates
- Discounts and scholarships — sibling, merit, custom
- Fines/late-fee rules
- Receipts — printable, emailed, SMS
- Reminders before due date and on default; defaulters list per batch

- Online payment — cards, UPI/QR, net banking, wallets
- Refund cutoff rules

3.9 Communication & portals

- Parent portal/app — attendance, homework, exam results, fee history, notices, direct teacher messaging, live bus tracking (if transport is used)
- Student portal — timetable, results, fee status, homework
- Teacher portal — attendance marking, grade entry, class material (without financial-data access)
- Multi-channel notifications — push, SMS, email, WhatsApp; multi-language support

3.10 Ancillary modules

- **Library** — catalog with ISBN/barcode, issue/return, automated fines, reservation/renewal, e-book integration
- **Transport** — GPS bus tracking, route optimisation, driver/vehicle database, boarding alerts, transport-fee calculation
- **Hostel** — room allocation, warden management, mess
- **HR/Payroll** — staff attendance and salary (institute's own staff)
- **Inventory/canteen**

3.11 Coaching-institute specifics

The distinguishing features for test-prep and tuition centres: rotating batches on different schedules rather than one fixed timetable, short/crash courses, flexible fee plans, doubt sessions as a headline feature, mock testing with rank analytics, study-material distribution, and per-session progress reports.

3.12 Full academy flow

Publish course + batch schedule

→ Open admissions (form / entrance test / invite) → Enroll student + link guardian

→ Assign to batch/section → Fee plan with installments → Collect payment

→ Mark attendance each session → Alert guardians on absence

→ Assign homework → Submit → Grade

→ Conduct tests/exams → Enter marks → Compute grades

→ Generate report card → Share with parent

→ Progress review → At-risk flags → Intervention

Approximate scope: ~20 modules, roughly 200+ discrete features.

Part 4 — Cross-Cutting Primitives (Common to All Three Verticals)

Regardless of vertical, the same underlying building blocks recur — which suggests these can be built once and reused across gym, office, and academy modules:

1. **Identity & access** — users, roles, permissions, multi-tenant isolation, MFA, session management
2. **People records** — a person entity with statuses and a lifecycle

- (member / employee / student)
3. **Attendance / check-in** — proof of presence, regardless of method (biometric, QR, RFID, manual)
 4. **Approvals & requests** — a generic routable approval object (leave, regularization, fee waiver, etc.)
 5. **Scheduling** — a time-and-capacity object (class, session, batch)
 6. **Billing** — recurring or transactional invoices, payments, refunds, dunning (gym and academy; optional for office)
 7. **Communication** — email, SMS, push, in-app notifications
 8. **Reporting** — trend and utilization dashboards built on the same underlying records
 9. **Audit log** — every state change, who did it, and when
-

Part 5 — Feature Count Summary

Vertical	Modules	Approx. discrete features
Gym / club	~20	150+
Office (HR/staff ops — corrected scope)	~7	50-60
Academy	~20	200+

Sources

Gym — Finegym · WellnessLiving · Zenoti · Nutripy · SafeTurnstile · i-PRO · SchedulingKit · Mindbody · Wellyx · HelloGrowthCRM · ABC Fitness · ClubWise · BRP · Daxko

Office — Chromosis · MangoApps · Freshservice (internal HR/ops sources; leasing/coworking/CAFM sources from the original research are omitted here as out of scope)

Academy — openSIS · Blackbaud · Alma · StudentX · Unity · Odoo schoolos_attendance · Zoho Creator · Blackboard · CYPHER Learning · Classplus · The Academix · Pro Solutions ERP · Lynk · TuitionDesk · Institute Run · AOne

Prepared as an internal reference for platform/feature planning. Figures (feature counts, conversion rates, churn benchmarks) are illustrative industry ranges drawn from vendor and operator sources, not guaranteed outcomes for any specific implementation.